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INDIA'S SHUKLA BACK ON EARTH AFTER SPACE MISSION

Indian astronaut and IAF Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla yesterday returned to Earth after a historic mission aboard the International Space Station (ISS). Shukla, who became the first Indian astronaut in over four decades to visit the ISS, successfully splashed down in the Pacific Ocean off the California coast at 3pm IST, completing Axiom Space's historic Axiom-4 (Ax-4) mission.

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UAE launches largest water supply project from Egypt to south Gaza

Operation Chivalrous Knight 3 endeavour part of emergency response

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

As part of the UAE's ongoing humanitarian relief efforts in Gaza, Operation "Chivalrous Knight 3" has announced the launch of the largest desalinated water supply project, aiming to address the acute water crisis in the Gaza Strip.

The initiative involves the construction of a 315-mm-wide pipeline stretching 6.7 kilometres, connecting a UAE-established desalination plant on the Egyptian side of the Rafah border to displacement areas between the Khan Younis and Rafah governorates in southern Gaza. The pipeline is described as the largest of its kind and

15 litres
of desalinated water
per person daily will
be provided

is expected to deliver 15 litres of desalinated water per person each day to approximately 600,000 Palestinians.

The project was announced during a press conference held at the headquarters of the Coastal Municipalities Water Utility (CMWU) in Deir Al Balah. It comes as a direct response to the collapse of Gaza's water infrastructure, over 80 per cent of which has been destroyed amid ongoing hostilities.

Officials stressed that the project is not only an emergency response but part of a broader, long-term Emirati strategy to support the Palestinian people. "This new water pipeline is more than a humani-

tarian intervention — it reflects a sustained commitment by the UAE to stand with Gaza in its most difficult times," said Sharif Al Nairab, media officer for Operation Chivalrous Knight 3 in Gaza.

"The UAE has consistently supported the water sector in Gaza — from establishing desalination plants and drilling wells, to supplying mobile tanks and rehabilitating networks. This project is a continuation of that legacy, aiming to bring clean drinking water to the areas most affected by war," he added.

Engineer Omar Shatat, Deputy Director General for Technical Affairs at the CMWU, extended deep gratitude to the UAE for its "unwavering support since the very first day of the war." He noted that Emirati aid has played a critical role in enabling local municipalities and institutions to restore essential services under exceptionally challenging conditions.

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Trump gives Russia 50-day truce deadline

US PRESIDENT VOWS 100% TARIFFS; MOSCOW SEEKS TIME TO RESPOND

WASHINGTON

Russia said yesterday it needed time to respond to US President Donald Trump's ultimatum to end the Ukraine war or face new sanctions but it was ready for fresh talks with Kyiv.

"President Trump's statement is very serious. We certainly need time to analyse what was said in Washington," Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov told reporters in Moscow's first reaction to the comments.

On Monday, Trump gave Russia 50 days to strike a peace deal with Ukraine, voicing fresh frustration with Moscow, and laid out an arrangement with Nato to supply Kyiv with new military aid sponsored by the alliance's member countries.

Trump warned that if no deal was concluded, he would slap "very severe tariffs" on Russia's trade partners in a bid to impede Moscow's ability to finance the war.

'Secondary tariffs'

"We're going to be doing very severe tariffs if we don't have a deal in 50 days, tariffs at about 100 per cent," Trump said Monday during a meeting with Nato Secretary General Mark Rutte at the White House.

Trump said the levies would come in the form of "secondary tariffs," without providing de-

The threats echo punishment spelled out in a bipartisan bill in Congress that would impose 500% tariffs on countries that buy Russian oil and gas.

tails. The US president has used the term in the past to describe duties imposed on countries for trading with American adversaries.

Asked later if Trump meant to refer to the more widely known tool "secondary sanctions," Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick told reporters that sanctions and tariffs were "both tools in his toolbox" and that "you can do either one." A White House official said Russia could face both measures if it fails to sign a ceasefire deal by early September.

The threats echo punishment spelled out in a bipartisan bill in Congress that would impose 500 per cent tariffs on countries that buy Russian oil and gas.

Peace talks on ending the conflict, now in its fourth year, have stalled.

But Peskov said Russia was still ready to negotiate and was "waiting for proposals from the Ukrainian side on the timing of the third round of direct Russian-Ukrainian negotiations".

— Agencies



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Dubai's cat woman gives new life to feline friends

Gollner saved 500 cats, rehomed many

DUBAI
BY LAKSHANA N PALAT
Assistant Features Editor

Theresa Gollner from Dubai has saved 500 cats, healed injured strays and found 60 loving homes abroad.

"I think I get it from my parents," she says. Gollner grew up in Austria, practically on a farm, with a pony, two donkeys, sheep and an overwhelming love for animals. That love only intensified when she moved to a small island in Indonesia in 2015. "There was only one small charity organisation," she recalls.

Moved by the plight of abandoned animals, she be-



gan bringing them to rescue centres. And so, this determination to help animals continued as she moved to Dubai in 2020, during the pandemic, while fostering a mother and kittens.

And since then, for the past 4-and-a-half years, she has been fostering, rescuing cats, or getting them for TNR (trap, neuter, and return), sending them overseas to comfortable homes.

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